RULES GUIDEBOOK · 2 TO 6 STALLS · 45 TO 90 MINUTES



FRUIT MARKET

HOW MUCH CAN YOU CHARGE BEFORE YOUR RIVAL, OR THE ROT, GETS YOU?

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THE BIG IDEA

Each player runs a small fruit stall. You buy fruit from the Wholesale Market in the morning and sell it to the town's customers the same day. Fruit gets older every night, so whatever you buy, you are racing to sell it. The stall with the most cash at the end of the last day wins.

Three things pull against you every day:

1. **The clock.** Every night all fruit gets one step older. Older fruit sells for less, and then it is thrown away.
2. **The secret price.** You never see a rival's prices until the bell. Price too high and the customer walks past you. Price too low and you give money away.
3. **The shut crate.** Stalls are secret. Before prices are set you learn only how many pieces each rival put out, not which fruit.

WHAT IS NEW IN RULES VERSION 17

Tomorrow's customers in the morning. Tomorrow's row is dealt each morning, with tomorrow's lorry, so everyone buys knowing today's crowd and tomorrow's.

Standing orders in the open. Everyone sees who is bidding and who has passed, never the price, and you may change your mind until the last stall decides. A rival who fills a gap is paid $1 under the winning bid.

Cash is public and sits on your counter, in front of the shutter. The stall sheet no longer has a cash track.

WHAT IS IN THE BOX

1 Wholesale Market board (three panels) · 6 stall sheets, 6 shutters and 6 counters (each counter carries a cash track) · 200 fruit pieces, 50 of each fruit · 24 price tags, four per stall · 12 cash markers, two per stall · 36 served-alone chips, six per stall · 36 customer cards and 5 guest cards · 20 event cards and 20 lorry cards · 18 favour cards · 30 upgrade cards, six of each · 8 standing-order cards · 8 shopkeeper cards · day marker, first-player token, Shade Cloth marker, six +$200 chips. You also need a dry-wipe pen or pencil for each stall.

THE FRUIT

Every fruit follows the same rule. A **Fresh** piece sells at the customer's full price. An **Okay** piece sells for $1 less. A **Soft** piece sells for $2 less. **Green** fruit cannot be sold until it ripens. A fruit's last two days are Okay, then Soft; every day before that is Fresh. Mangoes always arrive Green and spend two nights ripening first.

Each lane on the board, and on your stall sheet, is that fruit's life from right (newest) to left (oldest). Every night, every piece slides one box to the left. A piece that slides out of its Soft box is thrown away.

FRUIT	LASTS	ITS BOXES, OLDEST ON THE LEFT, WITH THE COST TO BUY FROM EACH
Blueberry	3 days	S $1 | O $1 | F $2
Watermelon	4 days	S $1 | O $2 | F $3 | F $3
Mango	5 days	S $1 | O $3 | F $6 | G $3 | G $3
Apple	6 days	S $1 | O $2 | F $3 | F $3 | F $3 | F $3

S = Soft, O = Okay, F = Fresh, G = Green. Every mango arrives green; no other fruit does.

CUSTOMERS

A customer card shows one or two fruits. For each one it shows how many they want (the circles) and the most they pay for a Fresh piece (the price tag). They pay $1 less for Okay and $2 less for Soft. The black band is the customer's freshness type: **Premium** buys Fresh fruit only; **Everyday** buys Fresh or Okay; **Bargain** buys Fresh, Okay or Soft.

The back of the card shows only which fruits they want. A face-down customer keeps their amounts, prices and type secret.

Each day brings one **regular** (drawn face up, a day ahead) and some **walk-ins** (drawn face down, a day ahead). The crowd is one customer per stall, and never more than five: the regular plus one walk-in for every stall after the first, up to four. With 6 stalls every customer wants one more of the first fruit on their card. Nobody waits overnight: a customer who does not get everything leaves.

SET-UP

1. **The board.** Open it in the middle of the table. Shuffle the 20 event cards and the 20 lorry cards and put each deck face down on its space. Put the day marker on 1. Agree the length: Quick is 8 days, Standard is 10, Long is 14.
2. **The supply.** Put all the fruit pieces in a pile within reach. The market starts empty.
3. **Each stall** takes a stall sheet, the shutter, the counter, cash markers and chips in the same pattern, four price tags and a pen. Stand the shutter in front of your sheet and lay the counter in front of the shutter: the shutter stays up all game. On your counter's cash track, put your Tens marker on 10 and your Ones marker on 0: you start with $10.
4. **First player.** Give the first-player token to a stall at random.
5. **Shopkeepers.** Lay the eight shopkeeper cards face up. Starting with the player to the left of the token, each stall picks one. It gives you one perk for the whole game. Saleh moves his cash to $18. Ah Chen draws four favour cards once the deck is ready.
6. **Favours and upgrades.** With 2 to 4 stalls, use two of each favour card (12 cards). With 5 or 6 stalls use all 18. Shuffle them face down beside the board. Lay the upgrade cards face up in five piles. Shuffle the eight standing-order cards face down beside them.
7. **Customers.** Shuffle the 36 customer cards. Keep the five guest cards to one side. Deal today's crowd in a row on the table: one regular face up, then one walk-in face down for every stall after the first, up to four.

MONEY: THE CASH TRACK

Your cash is your Tens marker plus your Ones marker, on the cash track on your **counter**, in front of your shutter. With Tens on 10 and Ones on 4 you have $14. When you are paid or you pay, move the Ones marker, and carry to the Tens marker when you pass 9 or go below 0. If you pass $199, take a +$200 chip and start the Tens again from 0.

Cash is public. Everyone can read everyone's cash at any time. Nobody hands money to anybody: each stall moves its own markers while the table watches.

A DAY IN FIVE BEATS

1 MORNING

1. **Event.** From Day 2 onward, turn over the top event card onto "Today's event" and do what it says. Nobody knows an event before its own morning. There is no event on Day 1. If the event adds walk-ins, deal them face down at the end of today's row. If it removes walk-ins, the last ones in today's row go back under the customer deck. If it brings a guest, add that guest card to the end of the row.
2. **The lorry.** The card on "Tomorrow's lorry" is now today's lorry (on Day 1, turn over the top card of the deck). Find the row for your number of stalls and take that many pieces of each fruit from the supply. Put them in that fruit's box marked "The lorry unloads here". Mangoes always arrive green and go in the far green box. The Seconds Lorry unloads its other fruit into each fruit's freshest Okay box.
3. **Tomorrow.** Discard today's lorry card and turn the next one face up onto "Tomorrow's lorry". Then deal **tomorrow's row** below today's: one regular face up and the walk-ins face down (use the "Daily" number on the board). Tomorrow's own event may change that row tomorrow morning. Deal nothing for the day after the last day.
4. **Market Day?** Turn over a standing order and bid for it now, before anyone buys (see Standing orders).

2 BUYING

The poorest stall buys first, then the others follow clockwise from it. If stalls tie for poorest, the first of them clockwise from the first-player token goes first. On Day 1, start at the token. This is today's buying order; the evening and the last tie-break use it too.

On your turn, buy up to 4 pieces. For each one, take a piece from any market box, pay the cost printed on that box, and put the piece on your shelf row, in the box with the same position in that fruit's lane (same letter, same distance from the Soft end). Your sheet holds 8 pieces in all. You may play Free Fruit, Scout or Fridge on your turn. Buying is done in the open, so you may remember what a rival took.

3 STOCKING

1. **The crowd arrives.** Turn today's walk-ins face up. The row is always in this order, left to right: a standing order collected today, the regular, the walk-ins in the order they were drawn, then a guest. The row never holds more than five cards: a guest, or a standing order, takes the place of the last walk-in.
2. **Fill your crate.** Behind your shutter, slide each piece you want to sell today straight up, from the shelf row into the crate box above it. Any freshness may go in; green fruit may not. Pieces left on the shelf cannot be sold today, and they still get older tonight.
3. **Say how many.** When everyone is ready, each stall says how many pieces are in its crate, and nothing else. Which fruit, and how fresh, stays secret until the bell.

You may not ask what is behind a shutter, and nobody has to tell you.

4 THE BELL

Write one price on the tag of each fruit you have in your crate, and lay the tag face down. One price covers every piece of that fruit. There is no lowest price. When everyone is ready, flip all tags together and lay each one on its fruit on your counter. Then every crate comes out: move your crate pieces from behind the shutter onto your counter, each into the box with the same letter and place. Your shelf stays behind the shutter. Play Favoured Trade now if you want it.

Your price decides which of your pieces can sell to a customer. Take the customer's top price for today (the price on the card, plus or minus any event, plus $1 on the last day): priced **at the top price**, only a Fresh piece sells; **$1 under**, a Fresh or Okay piece sells; **$2 under, or less**, any piece sells; **over the top price**, nothing sells to that customer. The customer must also accept the freshness: a Premium customer never takes Okay or Soft fruit, however cheap.

5 THE RUSH

Serve the customers one at a time, left to right. The stall that bought last this morning is the crier: they read each customer aloud. For each fruit on the card:

1. The customer buys from the cheapest stall that has a piece they will take at that price.
2. That stall hands over the oldest piece on its counter that is fresh enough for its price, puts it on one of the card's circles, and adds its own posted price to its cash track.
3. If the customer still wants more, they carry on with the same stall, and then spill to the next cheapest stall, until the circles are full or nobody else can sell.

Tied prices are broken in this order: a stall that played Favoured Trade; then the stall whose piece is younger; then Rosa the Haggler; then whoever bought earlier this morning.

Serving alone. The first stall to sell to a customer puts one of its chips on the card. If a second stall sells to the same customer, the chip comes off. When the whole order is filled and a chip is still there, that stall served the customer alone: it draws a favour card (one a day at most, and never past a hand of three).

After the last customer. Every customer leaves, served or not. Put any unsold counter pieces back behind the shutter, each in the same box of the shelf row, and wipe your tags.

EVENING AND NIGHT

Evening. In buying order, each stall may play evening favours (Priority, Gossip). On the evening after a Market Day (days 3, 6, 9 and 12) each stall may also build **one upgrade** from the five piles: pay its cost and take the card. A stall has room for 2. Pak Din lays the Shade Cloth marker on one fruit lane of his sheet. Farah peeks at one of tomorrow's walk-ins.

Night. On the board, and behind every shutter, every piece slides one box to the left. Pieces that slide out of a Soft box go back to the supply. Tomorrow's row moves up to become today's. Then pass the first-player token one seat clockwise and move the day marker on.

MARKET DAYS, CLOSING DAY AND THE END

Market Days are days 3, 6, 9 and 12, but never the last day. They bring a standing order in the morning and an upgrade that evening. The lorry still comes. **Closing Day** is the last day. Every customer pays $1 more. After the rush, the jam maker buys every ripe piece left on every stall for $1 each. Green fruit is worth nothing. **The winner** is the stall with the most cash. Upgrades are worth nothing. If stalls tie, the one that sold more fruit wins.

STANDING ORDERS

A standing order is one big public order. It is turned over on a Market Day morning and collected two days later. It wants one fruit, Fresh or Okay: 3 pieces at 2 or 3 stalls, 4 at 4 stalls, 5 at 5 or 6. Do not turn one over if its due day would be after the last day.

1. **Bid, in the open.** Before anyone buys, each stall decides. To bid, write on a price tag the price per piece you would fill the order for (from $1 up to the price on the card) and lay it face down in front of your shutter. To pass, say "pass". Everyone can see who is bidding and who has passed; nobody sees a price. **You may change your mind** (swap your tag, take it back, or put one down after passing) for as long as any stall is still deciding. When the last stall decides, flip all tags together. The lowest bid wins. A tie goes to a stall with an Order Book, then to the stall that buys earlier today. The winner puts one of its chips on the card. If everyone passes, discard the card.
2. **Get ready.** The winner has three buying turns (today, tomorrow and the due day) to have the pieces on its shelf.
3. **Collect.** On the due day the card stands at the front of the row and is served first, from the crates. It takes the winner's Fresh or Okay pieces first, freshest first, and pays the winner its bid for each. If it still wants more, it buys the freshest pieces rivals have put out, and pays them **$1 less than the winning bid** (never less than $1).
4. **Fine.** The winner pays the card's fine for every piece it did not supply itself, never more than its cash. An Order Book halves the fine.

ORDERS	FRUIT	HIGHEST BID ALLOWED	FINE A PIECE
The School Canteen, The Smoothie Stand	Blueberry	$9	$6
The Beach Resort, The Company Picnic	Watermelon	$12	$8
The Pie Factory, The Cider Press	Apple	$11	$7
The Airline Caterer, The Royal Banquet	Mango	$18	$12

A standing order draws no favour card and pays no tips, and no event or Closing Day changes what it pays. It is not used in the Basic game.

GUESTS

Five events bring a guest card. The guest joins the end of today's row and is served like any other customer. A guest's price is fixed: the event's own price change is not added to it. Only Closing Day adds its $1.

GUEST	EVENT	WANTS
The Gym Club	Superfood Trend	2 blueberries at $8
The Influencer	Mango Craze	1 mango at $15
The Hotel Chef	Hotel Order	1 apple at $8, 1 watermelon at $8, 1 blueberry at $7
The Wedding Caterer	Kenduri	3 watermelons at $8
The Bakery	Bake-Off	2 apples at $7

HOW MANY WALK-INS

STALLS	REGULAR + WALK-INS	FESTIVAL	TOURIST BUS	MONSOON DOWNPOUR
2	1 + 1	+1	+2	−1
3	1 + 2	+1	+2	−1
4	1 + 3	+1 (row full)	+1 (row full)	−2
5	1 + 4	row full	row full	−2
6	1 + 4, each wanting 1 more	row full	row full	−2

Never more than four walk-ins, and never fewer than none. An event changes today's row only, on its own morning.

EVENT CARDS (20)

EVENT	WHAT IT DOES TODAY
Festival	Customers pay $1 more per fruit. Add 1 walk-in (2 at 4–6 stalls), up to a row of five.
Superfood Trend	Blueberry customers pay $1 more each. Gym Club wants 2 Fresh/Okay blueberries at $8 each.
Mango Craze	Mango customers pay $2 more each. An influencer wants 1 Fresh mango at $15.
Hotel Order	Hotel Chef wants 1 apple ($8), 1 watermelon ($8) and 1 blueberry ($7). Fresh/Okay only.
Heatwave	Watermelon customers pay $2 more each. All fruit ages an extra step tonight.
Apple Blight	No apples arrive. Apple customers pay $2 more each.
Blueberry Glut	Deliver 1 extra per 2 stalls, rounded up. Blueberry customers pay $1 less each.
Good Harvest	Deliver 1 extra of each fruit per 4 stalls, rounded up. Customers pay $1 less per fruit.
Bad Harvest	Halve today’s delivery, rounded up. Customers pay $1 more per fruit.
Price Hike	All Wholesale Market fruit costs $1 more today.
Price Controls	Stall prices cannot exceed the limits shown today. Blueberry $5, watermelon $7, apple $6, mango $10.
Health Inspector	Before buying, pay $2 per Soft fruit on your shelf, up to your cash. Never the final day.
Lorry Breakdown	No delivery today. Existing market stock stays.
Tourist Bus	Add 2 walk-ins at 2–3 stalls, 3 at 4 stalls, or 4 at 5–6 stalls, up to a row of five. Prices unchanged.
Monsoon Downpour	Remove 1 walk-in (2 at 4–6 stalls). No fruit ages tonight, including market stock.
Durian Season	Wholesale fruit costs $1 less, minimum $1. Customers pay $1 less per fruit.
Kenduri	After walk-ins, a caterer wants 3 Fresh/Okay watermelons at $8 each.
Mango Windfall	Deliver 1 extra ripe mango per 2 stalls, rounded up. Mango customers pay $2 less each.
Pasar Malam	After the rush, a hawker buys 1 of each fruit left in every stall’s crate at $3 each. Any freshness!
Bake-Off	Apple customers pay $1 more each. The bakery wants 2 Fresh/Okay apples at $7 each.

"Customers pay $1 more" raises every customer's top price. A Heatwave night slides every piece two boxes. After a Monsoon Downpour nothing slides at all. The Health Inspector charges for the Soft pieces on your sheet before anyone buys: count them yourself, behind your shutter, and pay.

FAVOUR CARDS

You earn a favour by serving a customer's whole remaining order by yourself. Keep favours face down in front of you, so everyone can count them. Hold up to 3. A played card goes to a discard pile; shuffle the pile into a new deck when the deck runs out.

FAVOUR	WHEN	EFFECT
Gossip	Evening	Secretly see tomorrow's walk-ins: who they are, what they want, how many and their top price.
Free Fruit	Your buying turn	Take one fruit of your choice from the Wholesale Market for free.
Priority	Evening	You buy first tomorrow.
Scout	Your buying turn	Look at the front of one walk-in who arrives today. Everyone sees you played it, but not what you saw.
Favoured Trade	At the bell	You win every tied price today.
Fridge	Your buying turn	All your ripe fruit becomes one step fresher.

STALL UPGRADES

All five are on offer on the evening after each Market Day. Build one that evening at most. You can build each upgrade once, and a stall has room for 2.

UPGRADE	COST	EFFECT
Juice Bar	$4	+$1 for each okay or soft fruit you sell. Each night up to 2 pieces that would spoil become juice: $2 each. Tip: before the last day, $1 soft fruit makes $2 of juice.
Handcart	$6	Buy up to 5 pieces of fruit a day and hold 10.
Premium Display	$6	Your fresh fruit may be priced $1 above what customers normally pay.
Ripening Room	$6	Your green mangoes ripen in one night instead of two.
Order Book	$5	You win tied bids for standing orders, and your standing-order fines are halved.

SHOPKEEPERS

No two stalls can be the same shopkeeper. Everyone can see your perk.

SHOPKEEPER	PERK	EFFECT
Rosa	Haggler	You win tied prices against equally fresh fruit.
Uncle Benny	Big Basket	Buy 1 extra fruit every day, at the normal price.
Ah Chen	Charmer	Start with 4 favour cards, hold up to 4, and earn up to 2 favour cards a day.
Saleh	Nest Egg	Start with $18 instead of $10, and buy first on day 3.
Raj	Bargain Hunter	Your first fruit each day costs $1 less (never below $1).
Kiki	Tip Jar	Customers you serve completely by yourself tip you $2.
Pak Din	Shade Cloth	Each night, name one fruit: none of your pieces of that fruit age tonight.
Farah	Sharp Ears	Each evening, peek at one of tomorrow's walk-ins. A walk-in you have seen tips $1 if you sell to them ($2 at 4 to 6 stalls).

SMALL PRINT

WHEN A DECK RUNS OUT

Customers. Shuffle every customer card that is not on the table into a new deck. **Favours.** Shuffle the discard pile into a new deck; cards in hands stay there. **Events and lorries.** Shuffle all 20 again. **Fruit pieces.** If a pile ever runs out, use any stand-in.

REMINDERS PEOPLE ASK ABOUT

- The lorry comes every day, Market Days included, unless an event says otherwise.
- Only pieces in your crate can sell. Fruit on your shelf is safe from customers, but not from the night.
- You are paid your own posted price, not the customer's top price.
- You always hand over your oldest piece that is fresh enough for your price. You do not choose.
- A standing order takes rivals' crate pieces whether they like it or not, at $1 under the winning bid.
- Pasar Malam: after the last customer, the night hawker buys 1 of each fruit still in each stall's crate for $3, oldest piece first, any freshness.
- The Health Inspector never comes on the last day. If that card is drawn then, draw another.
- Scout: turn one face-down walk-in up for yourself only, look, and turn it back. Say aloud that you played it.

OTHER WAYS TO PLAY

OPTION	WHAT CHANGES
Basic game	No shopkeepers, favours, upgrades or standing orders: just buying, stocking and the bell. Good for a first game.
Fixed prices (beginner)	Ignore the prices on the cards. Every customer pays the same top price for a Fresh piece: blueberry $5, watermelon $7, apple $6, mango $11. Generous customers pay $2 more: numbers 6, 19 and 27.
No Market Days, or no Closing Day	Either can be switched off before you start.

The day on one line. Morning: event, lorry, tomorrow's lorry and tomorrow's customers, standing-order bids on a Market Day · Buying: poorest first, up to 4 · Stocking: fill the crate behind the shutter, say how many · The bell: one tag per fruit, flip together, crates out onto the counters · The rush: cheapest stall first, oldest fresh-enough piece, served-alone chips · Evening: favours, upgrades · Night: everything slides one box left.

These tabletop rules are rules version 17, the same rules the Fruit Market app plays by. The table pieces (the three-panel board, the crate row above the shelf, the cash track on the counter, the shutter and price tags) are how those rules are run by hand.